

BONUS #4 · FAST-READ EMERGENCY CARDS



# 15 Emergency Calm-Down Activities

For when a meltdown is already happening. No long explanations —  
just fast, simple steps you can read in seconds, anywhere.

15 TECHNIQUES · 1-3 MINUTES EACH · WORKS ANYWHERE

# How to Use This Bonus

1

These are for active meltdowns — read fast, act fast, keep your own voice calm.

2

Every card takes 1-3 minutes and needs nothing but a body and a few seconds.

3

If one technique doesn't help within 2 minutes, the card tells you what to try next.

4

Talking less and doing more works best in the moment — save the conversation for after.

5

Keep this list somewhere fast to grab: the car, a bag, or on the fridge.



# 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding



🕒 1-2 min

📍 Anywhere

**Do this now:**

1

**Name 5 things you can see**

2

**Name 4 things you can touch**

3

**Name 3 things you can hear (then 2 you can smell, 1 you can taste)**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Wall Push-Away"**



# Wall Push-Away



🕒 1 min

📍 Anywhere with a wall

**Do this now:**

1

**Place both palms flat on a wall**

2

**Push as hard as you can for 10 seconds**

3

**Release, shake out your arms, repeat 3 times**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Bear Hug Squeeze"**



# Bear Hug Squeeze



🕒 1 min

📍 Anywhere

**Do this now:**

1

**Wrap both arms around yourself tightly**

2

**Squeeze hard and hold for 10 seconds**

3

**Release slowly, then squeeze again 2 more times**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Straw Breathing"**



# Straw Breathing



🕒 1-2 min

📍 Anywhere

**Do this now:**

- 1** Pretend you're holding a straw
- 2** Breathe in through your nose for 3 counts
- 3** Breathe out slowly through the pretend straw for 6 counts



If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "5-4-3-2-1 Grounding"



# Cold Water Reset



🕒 1 min

📍 Near a sink or water bottle

**Do this now:**

1

**Run cool water over your hands, or hold a cold water bottle**

2

**Focus only on the feeling of the cold**

3

**Take 3 slow breaths while the water runs**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Bear Hug Squeeze"**



# Heavy Blanket Squeeze



🕒 1-3 min

📍 Anywhere with a blanket or pillow

**Do this now:**

1

**Wrap up tightly in a blanket or hug a heavy pillow**

2

**Press it against your body firmly**

3

**Rock gently side to side for 1 minute**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Rock and Hum"**





# Count Backwards From 20



⌚ 1 min

📍 Anywhere

**Do this now:**

1

**Say the number 20 out loud**

2

**Count backwards one number at a time, slowly**

3

**If you lose count, just start again at 20 — that's okay**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "5-4-3-2-1 Grounding"**



# Stomp It Out



🕒 1-2 min

📍 Anywhere with floor space

**Do this now:**

1

**Stomp your feet hard on the ground, one at a time**

2

**Do 10 stomps on each foot**

3

**Finish with 3 big, slow breaths standing still**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Wall Push-Away"**



# Silent Scream



⌚ 30 sec - 1 min

📍 Anywhere

**Do this now:**

1

**Open your mouth as wide as it goes**

2

**'Scream' with no sound coming out, using all your energy**

3

**Close your mouth, breathe out slowly through your nose**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Stomp It Out"**



# Push the Wall Down



🕒 1 min

📍 Anywhere with a wall

**Do this now:**

- 1 Stand facing a wall, arms straight out
- 2 Push like you're trying to move the wall, for 10 seconds
- 3 Rest 5 seconds, then push again, 3 times total



If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Tight Fist Release"



# Name 5 Things You Can Hear



🕒 1 min

📍 Anywhere

**Do this now:**

1

**Close your eyes if that feels okay**

2

**Listen carefully and count 5 different sounds**

3

**Say each one out loud as you notice it**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "5-4-3-2-1 Grounding"**



# Tight Fist Release



🕒 1 min

📍 Anywhere

**Do this now:**

1

**Make both hands into tight fists**

2

**Squeeze as hard as you can for 5 seconds**

3

**Open your hands wide and let your fingers go floppy**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Hand Massage"**



# Rock and Hum



🕒 1-2 min

📍 Anywhere to sit

**Do this now:**

- 1 Sit down and wrap your arms around your knees**
- 2 Rock gently forward and back**
- 3 Hum any low, steady sound while you rock**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Heavy Blanket Squeeze"**



# Step Outside Reset



🕒 2-3 min

📍 Anywhere with outdoor access

**Do this now:**

- 1 Step outside or near an open window if possible
- 2 Take 5 slow breaths of fresh air
- 3 Notice one thing in the sky and one thing on the ground



If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Cold Water Reset"





# Safe Corner Retreat



🕒 2-3 min

📍 A quiet corner or small space

**Do this now:**

- 1 Go to a quiet, low-stimulation spot**
- 2 Sit or lie down and make yourself small and comfortable**
- 3 Stay there until your breathing feels slow and even**



**If it doesn't work in 2 minutes: try "Heavy Blanket Squeeze"**

YOU GOT THROUGH IT



# Calm Restored

Every meltdown you help navigate teaches a little more self-regulation for next time. You're doing the hard, important work.